

Off-Campus Job Search & Cold Outreach Blueprint

Targeting SDE-1 / Software Engineer Roles | 2026 Graduation Batch

1. Top Tier Platforms for Tech Roles

Platform	Best For	Action Strategy
LinkedIn	Recruiter outreach, hiring posts, alumni referrals	Search ' <i>hiring MERN</i> ' or ' <i>hiring SDE1</i> ' under posts filtered by Past 24h. Send personalized connection notes.
Wellfound (AngelList)	High-growth startups, remote & AI tech roles	Complete 100% profile. Apply directly to Founder/CTO with a tailored 3-bullet pitch highlighting K6Lab & AI tools.
Instahyre	Top Indian startups & product unicorns (Swiggy, Razorpay, etc.)	Instahyre uses AI matching. Keep skills updated (React, Node, Express, MongoDB, Data Structures, Redis).
Cutshort	Direct chat with engineering managers & founders	Take skill assessments (React / Node) to earn verified badges. High reply rate.
Hirist / iimjobs	Mid-sized to large tech companies & fintechs	Set daily job alerts for 'SDE Intern', 'Junior Backend', 'Frontend Developer'.
YC Work at a Startup	US/Global Y-Combinator backed AI startups	Apply directly at workatastartup.com . Startup founders value full-stack AI project experience.

2. Cold Emailing & Outreach System

Cold emails have a 3x higher conversion rate than blind portal applications if written crisply.

PROVEN COLD EMAIL TEMPLATE

Subject: Full-Stack Engineer (MERN + AI) | 7th Sem Engineer — Jay

Hi [Hiring Manager / Founder Name],

I saw [Company Name] is building [mention product feature]. As a Full-Stack MERN developer who recently built **K6Lab** and an **AI-powered Productivity Tool**, I love solving performance and full-stack architecture challenges.

Quick Highlights of My Work:

- **K6Lab / AI Tools:** Built scalable REST APIs, integrated LLM workflows, optimized Mongo aggregations & React state.
- **DSA & Problem Solving:** Solved 150+ core algorithmic problems across Patterns (HashMap, DP, Monotonic Stack, Graphs).
- **GitHub / Live Demo:** github.com/jayOnWeb

I would love 15 minutes to share how I can contribute to your engineering team. Are you available for a brief chat this week?

Best regards,

Jay | Full Stack Developer

3. ATS Resume Optimization Checklist

- **Single Page Standard:** Clean 1-column layout without tables or heavy graphic elements.
- **Action + Impact Format:** 'Engineered X using Y, resulting in Z% performance improvement'.
- **Highlight AI & Architecture:** Clearly list Node.js, React, Express, MongoDB, Redux/Zustand, Docker/Git, REST APIs, AI Integration.
- **Hyperlink Proof of Work:** Make GitHub, Deployed URLs (Vercel), and LeetCode profile links clickable.